

Windows tablet

Samsung to ruffle feathers with 10-inch Windows 7 QWERTY tablet - Galaxy Tab Gloria: <http://bit.ly/eLPSPg>

Windows 8

Windows 8 rumoured to have graphic intensive Wind interface for high-end computers: <http://bit.ly/h006rQ>

Street smart

Stay Informed

Things to consider before buying

Consumerism is growing and achieving ample recognition among the masses. Growing trends of consumer rights awareness is now evident. However, popular conception of consumer rights is becoming synonymous with enforcement of rights through consumer forums only. While consumerism per se is a wide concept not confined to enforcement but also to prevention, consumer information, safety, consumer education, redressal rights and related consumer aspects, the enforcement through consumer forums has its own peculiar role. Beyond that when we talk about the consumer rights, "information" on related aspects of consumer rights plays a vital role for a consumer. Information from a consumer prospective means to have information relevant for pre purchase till post purchase.

An intelligent purchase requires pre-purchase product research. When we say research, it refers to general

consultation and inquiry regarding the product. Even asking your friends who've purchased the product recently constitutes pre-purchase product research. You can also gain valuable information by going through web sites for well informed reviews of the product and expert comments. Finally, arrive at your decision keeping in view your needs and budget.

You can also have product information from the regulatory authorities under the Right to Information Act. By making a simple application with a nominal fee, you can get all relevant information for your product if it is endorsed. The endorsement is granted by the Government of India with ISI marks, Star ratings, and other standards such as AGMARK. For example, if you're considering an electrical product, look for Star ratings. If you have doubts about energy efficiency, you can get related information from the relevant Government department.

The internet is a useful resource to get relevant information about the product. In the current market scenario, no company can survive without having a user-friendly web site. Company web sites generally contain a lot of information relevant for the product you would be considering to buy. Most of this informa-

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We can help!

If you're facing a problem with your purchase, write to us at help@consumermate.com

tion would generally not be available with the shopkeeper or showroom. This helps you understand popular terminologies to arrive at an informed decision.

As a consumer, you need to be informed about factors that go beyond the product you are looking to purchase. These include excellence, effectiveness, wholesomeness, standard and price of goods or services that would protect you against unfair trade practices. No one can charge you more than the MRP specified on the product package (it is mandatory for the company to print MRP on the package). If someone charges you more than the MRP printed on the product, you can lodge a complain with the weights and measurement department and the consumer court as well.

Consumer rights are meant to safeguard your valuable rights. But as the saying goes, "prevention is better than cure". So, we should equip ourselves with some awareness and knowledge that can go a long way in saving our valuable time and money and avoiding harassment at the hand of the seller and service provider. **[1]**

COMPLAINTS RECEIVED

Mobile Phones

1. Poor battery Micromax mobile

Question: I purchased a Micromax mobile (model no. Q3) from telephone shopee based in Kothrud, Pune. I am facing a lot of problems due to this phone. After purchasing the handset, within weeks I faced a problem of 'phone not charging', and immediate discharging of phone. I contacted the service centre, and they replaced my batteries twice. They also changed the software once, and yet I still face the same problem. I had contacted the nearest Micromax service centre (Infinity Solutions) at Pasalkar Bhavan, Shivajinagar, Pune. They rectified the problem. After two days I faced the

same problem. They returned it back. I visited the service center 3 to 4 times to rectify the problem. Within two months I have faced a lot of problems, and whenever I go to service center, I have to take leave from my job. It is so hectic for me. Please do the needful. My job order sheet number is 1606. It reflects some pending work. This time I don't want any service from the centre. Either handover a new piece, or refund my money. Otherwise I would have to proceed to the Consumer court situated at Bibvewadi, Pune. Waiting for your reply.

Kiran Harpude

Answer By Consumermate:

Dear Customer,
This is height of poor quality services by any company. I must appreciate that you are aware of your valuable consumer rights. They cannot hold you waiting beyond a reasonable period. You can establish your claim for the new handset as the problems seems to be inherent to the product. You can also write a registered letter to the company claiming that this problem in product was inherent which is bothering you time and again. Keep a record of all the communications exchanged. If, there is nothing positive turns out then you can file a consumer complaint against them for which you can always seek out guidance.